



FACULTY OF ENGINEERING, SCIENCES AND TECHNOLOGY

Student Project Report

Analyzing a Real-Life Issue

Introduction to Philosophy & Critical Thinking

Project Title

“Think Critically: A Philosophical Analysis of a Real-Life Problem”

Project Topic: Artificial Intelligence and Human Future

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A Philosophical and Critical Thinking Analysis

PROJECT GANTT CHART

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PROJECT TITLE	Artificial Intelligence and Human Future	COURSE	Philosophy & Critical Thinking
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1. Introduction

Artificial Intelligence (AI) has become one of the most important technological developments of the modern world. It refers to the development of computer systems and machines that can perform tasks that normally require human intelligence, such as learning, problem-solving, decision-making, language understanding, image recognition, and pattern analysis. AI is no longer limited to research laboratories, it is now being used in education, healthcare, business, transportation, entertainment, communication, and many other areas of everyday life.

The rapid development of AI raises an important philosophical question, **what will the future of human beings look like in a world increasingly influenced by Artificial Intelligence?** AI can provide many benefits, including improved efficiency, faster decision-making, better access to information, and solutions to complex problems. However, it also creates concerns about employment, privacy, human freedom, responsibility, inequality, and the possibility of machines replacing certain forms of human work and decision-making.

The issue is important because AI is not simply a technological development. It directly affects fundamental philosophical questions about **human nature, knowledge, freedom, responsibility, and the meaning of human intelligence.** The central concern is not only whether machines can become more intelligent, but also how humans should use this intelligence and what limits should be placed on it.

We selected this topic because AI is a universal experience that affects everyone's daily life. As a group, we observed that many people blindly follow technology trends without critically examining their impact on human behavior, mental health, and decision-making. This topic directly connects to our course themes of human nature, knowledge, freedom, and critical thinking.

This report analyzes Artificial Intelligence and the human future from different philosophical perspectives. It also applies critical thinking by examining arguments, evidence, assumptions, strengths, weaknesses, alternative viewpoints, and common logical fallacies related to AI.

2. Philosophical Perspective

2.1 The Optimistic Perspective: AI as a Tool for Human Progress

One philosophical perspective views Artificial Intelligence as a powerful tool that can improve human life. As philosopher Ernst Kapp argued, technology serves as an extension of human organs and abilities, a view that aligns with seeing AI as a tool for human progress rather than a threat to it. According to this viewpoint, technology itself is neither inherently good nor bad. Its value depends largely on how human beings develop and use it.

AI can help humans solve problems that would otherwise require enormous amounts of time and resources. For example, AI can assist doctors in analyzing medical information, help researchers study large amounts of scientific data, support students in learning, and improve transportation and communication systems.

From this perspective, AI should be understood as an extension of human abilities rather than a replacement for humanity. Humans create AI, establish its objectives, and decide how it should be used. Therefore, AI can contribute to human progress when it is developed responsibly.

This viewpoint also suggests that throughout history, humans have developed tools that changed the way they live and work. Machines reduced the need for physical labor, computers transformed information processing, and the internet transformed communication. AI can be seen as another stage in this technological development.

The optimistic philosophical position therefore argues that humans should not automatically fear AI. Instead, society should focus on developing ethical rules, education, and responsible systems that allow humans to benefit from AI while controlling its risks.

2.2 The Critical Perspective: AI and the Risk to Human Autonomy

A second philosophical perspective is more cautious about the future of Artificial Intelligence. As Martin Heidegger warned in *The Question Concerning Technology*, technology risks reducing humans to mere resources, a concern directly relevant to AI's potential impact on human autonomy. It argues that excessive dependence on intelligent machines could negatively affect human autonomy and decision-making.

Human beings have traditionally made decisions using reasoning, experience, emotions, moral judgment, and personal responsibility. If people increasingly depend on AI systems to make decisions for them, there is a possibility that humans may gradually lose some of their ability to think independently.

For example, if students use AI to complete every assignment instead of developing their own reasoning skills, they may become dependent on technology. Similarly, if organizations rely completely on algorithms for employment, financial decisions, or other important matters, questions arise about who should be held responsible when an AI system makes an unfair or incorrect decision.

This perspective also raises questions about privacy and human freedom. AI systems can process enormous amounts of information about individuals. If such systems are used without appropriate limitations, personal information could be misused.

Therefore, the critical perspective does not necessarily argue that AI should be rejected. Instead, it emphasizes that technological development must remain under meaningful human control.

2.3 Humanistic Perspective: What Makes Humans Unique?

Another important philosophical question is whether intelligence is the only quality that makes humans valuable. As John Searle's Chinese Room thought experiment illustrates, a machine can produce intelligent-seeming output without genuine understanding, suggesting that human consciousness remains fundamentally distinct from machine intelligence.

AI can perform many tasks associated with intelligence, but human beings possess qualities such as emotions, consciousness, empathy, moral responsibility, creativity, relationships, and personal experiences. These qualities raise an important question: **Can intelligence alone make a machine equivalent to a human being?**

A machine may produce an intelligent answer, but this does not automatically prove that it understands the meaning of the answer in the same way a human does. Human experiences are connected to emotions, relationships, culture, values, and consciousness.

From a humanistic perspective, the development of AI should therefore not be measured only by how intelligent machines become. It should also be judged according to whether technology supports human dignity, freedom, creativity, relationships, and well-being.

3. Critical Thinking Analysis

3.1 Main Argument

The main argument of this report is:

Artificial Intelligence can significantly improve the human future, but its benefits depend on responsible human control, ethical principles, and critical thinking. AI should assist human beings rather than eliminate human responsibility and independent judgment.

This argument recognizes both the opportunities and risks of AI. It avoids the extreme position that AI will automatically save humanity or automatically destroy it.

3.2 Evidence and Reasons

Several reasons support the main argument.

a) AI Can Increase Efficiency

AI can process large amounts of information much faster than humans. This can help organizations identify patterns, automate repetitive tasks, and make informed decisions.

b) AI Can Support Education

AI-based educational tools can provide explanations, practice exercises, feedback, and personalized learning assistance. However, students still need to develop their own understanding and critical thinking skills.

c) AI Can Support Healthcare

AI can assist medical professionals by analyzing information and identifying patterns. It can potentially support earlier detection of certain problems and improve efficiency.

d) AI Can Support Scientific Research

Researchers can use AI to analyze complex datasets and explore possibilities that may be difficult to identify manually.

e) AI Can Create New Opportunities

Although AI may replace some existing tasks, it can also create new careers and fields. The future workforce may require people to develop new technical, creative, and interpersonal skills.

f) AI Creates Ethical Challenges

AI can also create serious concerns, including privacy problems, biased decision-making, misinformation, job displacement, and excessive dependence on technology. These challenges demonstrate why human oversight is necessary.

3.3 Assumptions

The argument about AI and the human future contains several important assumptions.

First, it assumes that human beings will remain responsible for deciding how AI is developed and used.

Second, it assumes that appropriate ethical rules and regulations can reduce the negative effects of AI.

Third, it assumes that humans can adapt to technological change through education and the development of new skills.

Fourth, it assumes that human intelligence and human values have qualities that should not be completely replaced by machines.

Finally, it assumes that technological progress should serve human well-being rather than becoming an independent goal.

These assumptions should be critically examined because if they are incorrect, the expected benefits of AI may not be achieved.

3.4 Strengths and Weaknesses of the Argument

Strengths

a) Balanced Approach

The argument does not describe AI as completely good or completely bad. It recognizes both its advantages and disadvantages.

b) Focus on Human Responsibility

It emphasizes that humans must remain responsible for important decisions involving AI.

c) Supports Technological Progress

The argument does not reject innovation. Instead, it supports responsible development and use of AI.

d) Considers Ethical Issues

It recognizes that technological progress must be connected with ethical principles such as fairness, privacy, responsibility, and human dignity.

e) Encourages Critical Thinking

Rather than accepting AI blindly, the argument encourages people to question its effects and evaluate evidence before making conclusions.

Weaknesses

f) Difficulty of Maintaining Human Control

As AI systems become more complex, controlling and understanding every decision made by advanced systems may become increasingly difficult.

g) Economic Disruption

AI may automate certain jobs and tasks, creating financial difficulties for workers whose skills become less demanded.

h) Dependence on Technology

Excessive dependence on AI could reduce human practice in areas such as independent reasoning, creativity, and problem-solving.

i) Bias and Incorrect Decisions

AI systems learn from data and can sometimes reproduce errors or biases present in that data.

j) Uncertainty about the Future

The long-term effects of AI cannot be predicted with complete certainty. Therefore, some arguments about the distant future are necessarily based on assumptions.

3.5 Possible Alternative Viewpoints

There are several alternative viewpoints concerning AI and humanity.

Viewpoint 1: AI Will Mostly Benefit Humanity

Supporters of this position believe AI will increase productivity, improve healthcare and education, solve complex problems, and create new opportunities. They argue that humans have historically adapted to technological change.

Viewpoint 2: AI Will Cause Major Social Problems

Critics argue that AI may increase unemployment, inequality, misinformation, surveillance, and dependence on technology. They believe strong regulations are necessary.

Viewpoint 3: AI Will Transform Rather Than Replace Humans

According to this position, the most likely future is not humans versus machines but humans working together with machines. AI may perform certain tasks while humans focus on creativity, communication, leadership, emotional understanding, and moral judgment.

Viewpoint 4: Human Values Must Remain Central

This viewpoint argues that technological progress should not be considered successful simply because machines become more capable. True progress should improve human life while protecting freedom, dignity, responsibility, and social well-being.

4. Logical Fallacies

The course requires the identification of logical fallacies related to the selected issue. The following are common fallacies that can appear in discussions about Artificial Intelligence.

4.1 Appeal to Fear – Relevance Fallacy

An appeal to fear attempts to convince people by creating fear instead of providing sufficient logical evidence.

Example:

“AI will become smarter than humans, take every person’s job, and destroy society, so AI development must be stopped immediately.”

The statement focuses heavily on frightening possibilities without providing sufficient evidence that these events will definitely happen.

Why It Is a Fallacy:

Fear alone is not evidence. A logical argument should evaluate probabilities, evidence, risks, and possible solutions instead of relying only on emotional reactions.

4.2 Hasty Generalization – Defective Induction

Hasty generalization occurs when someone reaches a broad conclusion from insufficient evidence.

Example:

“An AI chatbot gave me a wrong answer once, therefore all AI systems are unreliable.”

One incorrect response is not enough evidence to conclude that every AI system is unreliable.

Why It Is a Fallacy:

The conclusion is much broader than the evidence provided. A proper evaluation would require examining multiple systems, situations, accuracy rates, and types of AI.

4.3 False Dilemma – Presumption Fallacy

A false dilemma presents only two possible choices when more alternatives actually exist.

Example:

“Either we completely trust Artificial Intelligence, or we reject AI completely.”

This statement incorrectly suggests that society has only two choices.

Why It Is a Fallacy:

There are many possibilities between complete acceptance and complete rejection. Society can regulate AI, limit its use in certain areas, require human oversight, or use AI only for specific purposes.

4.4 Ambiguity Fallacy

Ambiguity occurs when an important word or phrase carries multiple meanings, and an argument shifts between those meanings without acknowledgment.

Example:

A common real-life example of this fallacy in AI discussions is the statement:

"AI is becoming more intelligent every day, and since it is now so intelligent, it will soon think and feel just like humans do."

Here, the word "intelligent" is used ambiguously. In the first part of the sentence, intelligence refers to computational ability, the capacity to process data, recognize patterns, and perform tasks efficiently. In the second part, the same word is stretched to imply human-like consciousness, emotion, and subjective experience. These are fundamentally different concepts, yet the argument treats them as identical without justification.

Why It Is a Fallacy:

This is a fallacy because assuming that computational intelligence and human consciousness are the same thing has not been established. John Searle's Chinese Room argument directly challenges this assumption, a machine can produce intelligent-seeming responses without any genuine understanding of meaning or experience.

5. Group Position: What Do We Think and Why?

Our group believes that *“Artificial Intelligence will become an important part of the human future, but it should remain a tool under responsible human control rather than becoming a replacement for human judgment and responsibility”*.

We do not believe that AI should simply be accepted without questioning its consequences. At the same time, completely rejecting AI would ignore its potential benefits.

Our position is grounded in logical reasoning. AI can improve human productivity by performing repetitive and complex tasks efficiently, and it can support important human activities such as education, research, healthcare, and communication. However, humans possess qualities that should remain central to decision-making, including moral responsibility, empathy, emotional understanding, personal experience, and social relationships. AI should not be trusted blindly, particularly when its decisions affect people's rights, opportunities, safety, or future.

Furthermore, we believe that education is essential for navigating the AI future. People must learn how to use AI responsibly and how to critically evaluate AI-generated information. Human oversight should remain in place for important decisions, as transferring complete authority to machines without appropriate human involvement carries serious risks. Ethical principles such as privacy, fairness, transparency, accountability, and human dignity must guide the development and use of AI at every level.

Therefore, our group does not support either extreme position. We do not believe that AI is automatically humanity's enemy, nor do we believe that AI will automatically solve all human problems. We believe the future will depend largely on how intelligently, ethically, and responsibly human beings choose to develop and use Artificial Intelligence.

6. Conclusion

Artificial Intelligence is one of the most significant developments shaping the future of humanity. It offers enormous possibilities for improving education, healthcare, scientific research, business, communication, and everyday life. At the same time, it creates important concerns about employment, privacy, human autonomy, responsibility, bias, and dependence on technology.

The philosophical analysis shows that AI is not simply a technical issue. It is closely connected with fundamental questions about human nature, knowledge, freedom, responsibility, and the meaning of intelligence.

The critical thinking analysis demonstrates that both extreme optimism and extreme fear can lead to weak reasoning. Instead of assuming that AI will either save humanity or destroy it, we should examine evidence, identify assumptions, recognize weaknesses, consider alternative viewpoints, and avoid logical fallacies.

Our group concludes that Artificial Intelligence should be developed and used as a means of supporting human beings rather than as a replacement for human values and responsibility. Humans must remain actively involved in important decisions and must establish ethical boundaries for the use of AI.

Ultimately, the future of Artificial Intelligence is also a question about the future of humanity itself. The most important question is not simply “How intelligent can machines become?” but rather “How wisely will humans use the intelligence they create?”

A successful AI future will therefore require not only technological innovation but also critical thinking, ethical reasoning, responsible decision-making, and respect for human dignity.